

Making The Storyboard

The procedure itself is quite simple—paper, pencil, and an idea. Like we mentioned before, the storyboard is made in comic-book fashion, with each frame depicting a new scene or a new camera angle. Don't worry—drawing skills aren't necessary. If you can draw half-decent stick figures to represent characters, it will do well enough.

If nothing else, just write down a description of every scene.

Filling It Up

Now that you've planned your movie, you'll need to go out and get the raw footage to fill it up. One rule to follow is the most obvious—record plenty of video. A general guideline is that every hour of final edited video comes out of more than four hours of actual shooting, especially if you're shooting loads of vacation videos. While you've got all the artistic freedom you want, keep in mind these few things:

1. The Establishing Shot

As the name suggests, the establishing shot basically sets the scene. If you're going to an amusement park, for example, the establishing shot can be a wide pan of the entire park. Alternatively, you could just start off with a shot of people screaming their heads off on the rollercoaster. Either way, the establishing shot is one which is a clear indicator of what's to come.

2. The Closing Shot

Just like you need an establishing shot to begin a scene, you will need a closing shot that brings your video to a logical end. This is another area where you can go wild. The closing shot may be as simple as shutting a door, but if it ties in well with the rest of your video, it's sure to make a lasting impression.

3. Cutaways

When you're editing out unnecessary video from your footage, you might often end up with what is called a "jump-cut"—an editing anomaly that causes a jarring disconnect in viewers' minds. For